SOMAIYA VIDYAVIHAR UNIVERSITY
K J Somaiya Institute of Management

Session 1 – Introduction to HRM in Healthcare

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Session Objectives

- LO1 Introduce human resources and describe the purpose, scope and processes in managing Human Resources in healthcare setup.
- LO2 Identify and explain the roles of various stakeholders (e.g., employees, line managers, HR, leadership, investors) in HRM.
- LO3 Discuss how internal (e.g., culture, leadership) and external (e.g., labor laws, market competition) forces shape HR practices.

“Hospital without Humans”

- Imagine a fully automated hospital — robots, AI, everything managed by tech.
- “What’s missing?”

Value of Human Resources

- Human resources are of critical importance, alongside other valuable intangibles of a healthcare organization such as brand value and customer relationships.

- Attracting, developing and retaining talented people can provide an organization with the resources it needs to prosper, grow and, ultimately, gain competitive advantage.

For example, the right manager, a dynamic CEO or a motivated health care workforce can transform the fortunes of an organization in a short period of time from the bottom of the pile onto the top

Value of Human Resources Management

- Human resource management (HRM) is about the overall process of managing people in organizations so that they are motivated and able to perform to their potential.
- A robust and well-designed HRM process will maximise the overall effectiveness of the organization in meeting its goals.
- An organization's HRM system at its most basic level administers people management systems which support broader organizational activities

HRM in Healthcare vs Other sectors

- While the core principles of HRM remain consistent across industries, the context, workforce characteristics, and organizational goals in healthcare make its HR management uniquely complex and sensitive.
- Compare how HRM in healthcare differs from typical industries e.g. Manufacturing, IT, Services etc.
- Look at:

Core mission , workforce composition, availability of manpower, nature of work, work hours and schedule, autonomy at work, performance measurement, learning opportunities, emotional demands, ethical sensitivity ,impact of errors, motivation drivers, reporting structure, professional collaboration

- Let us look at a few caselets
- Please work in groups

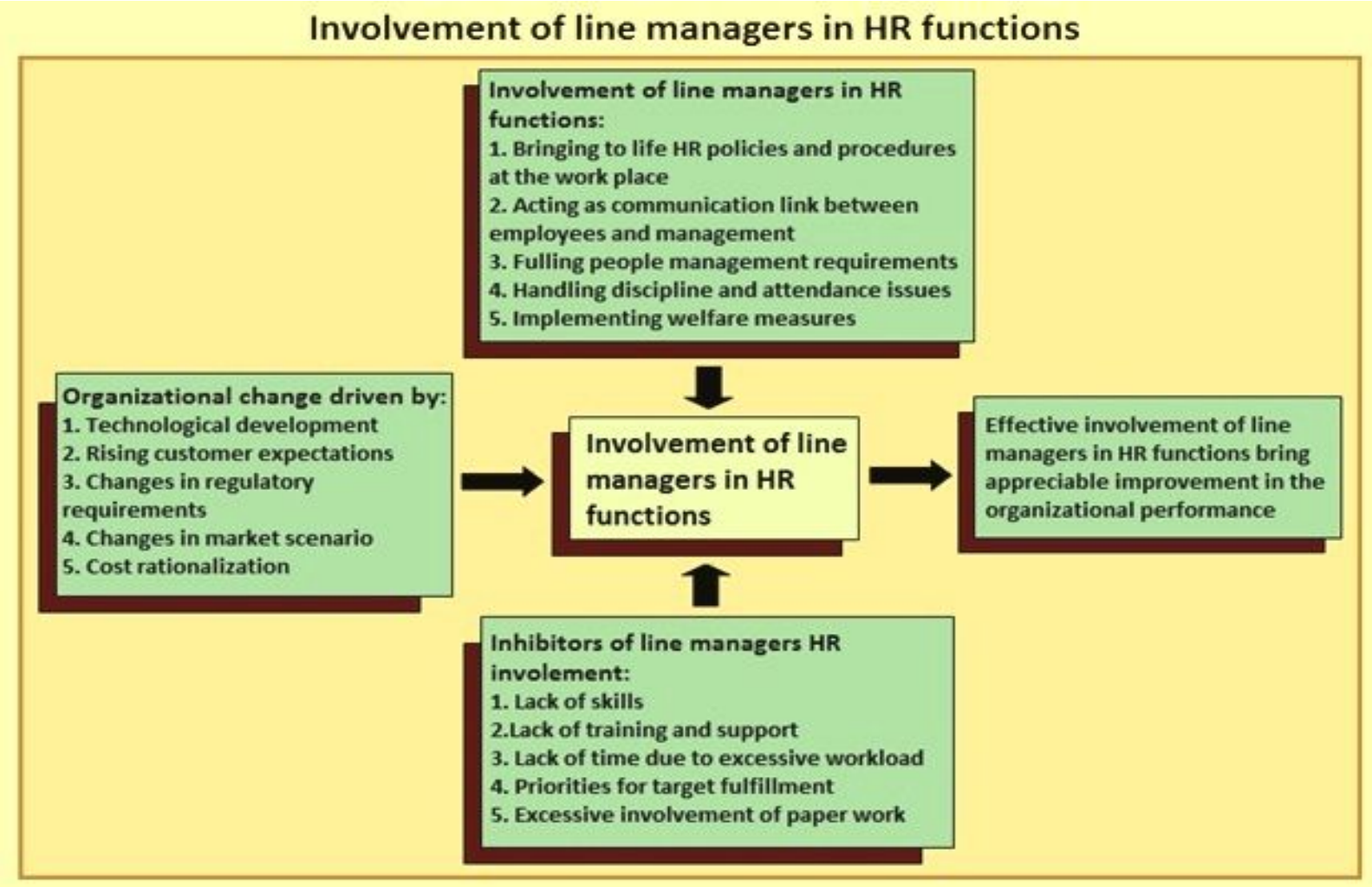
Core functions in HRM

Human Resource Functions spans across entire employee life cycle and the organization life cycle.

Policies for implementing core functions

- HRM involves creation of policies, practices, procedures and systems that influence the behaviour, attitudes, values and performance of people who work for the organization.
- Are plans of action that promote stability.
- Organizations need to evolve HR policies as they ensure consistency and uniformity in treating people.
- Become benchmarks to evaluate performance

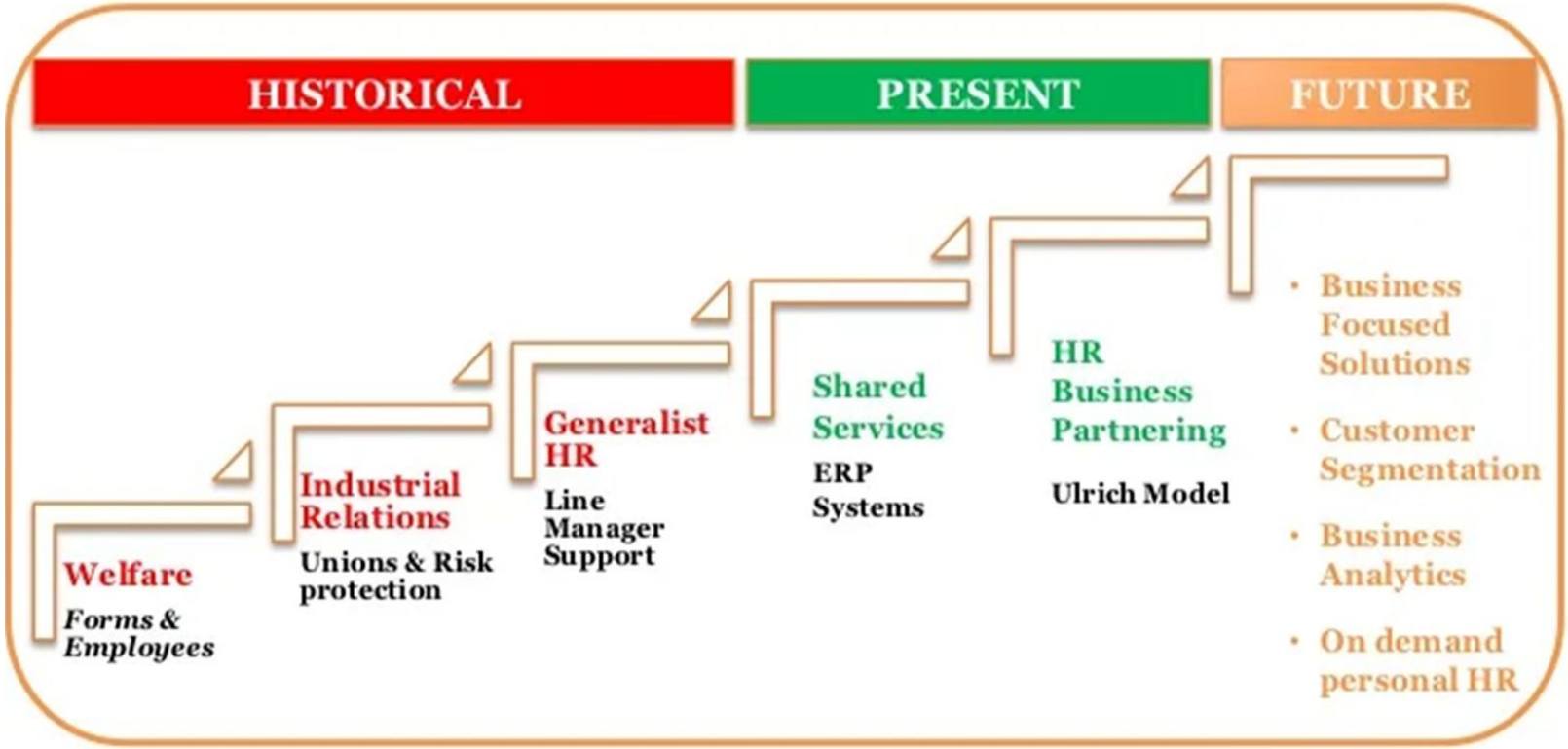
- It is useful to view the 'HR function' as a broadly dispersed people management competence (line managers) in an organization rather than just the activities carried out by specialists in the HR department



A line manager is responsible for managing employees and resources to achieve specific functional or organizational goals. Some of these include:

- Recruiting and hiring talent to fill team positions
- Providing training and support to new hires
- Cross-training employees to ensure job rotation and minimize assignment coverage gaps
- Providing coaching and performance feedback to all team members
- Communicating and ensuring understanding of functional or departmental goals
- Monitoring individual and team metrics and performance versus targets
- Identifying the need for corrective actions
- Ensuring quality standards for all processes
- Evaluating overall team and individual performance and delivering performance reviews
- Engaging and coordinating with other line managers across the organization
- Providing reports on productivity and other performance indicators to management

Evolution of Human Resources Management



The Context of HRM

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Incident	Classification	Action
Multiple hospitals (e.g., **KIMS Kerala**, **Safdarjung Hospital** Delhi) faced strikes demanding fair wages and working hours in the period 2017 - 22		
Technology Shift to EMR/ EHR (e.g., Narayana Health, Apollo)		
Entry of Corporate Healthcare (e.g., Fortis, Max Healthcare in India)		
High Doctor/Nurse Turnover at AIIMS Delhi (Historical) – Internal: Culture & workload		
Fortis internal audits 2017–18 revealed poor communication & trust gaps.)		
Aster DM Healthcare adding new units		
Medication Error at a US Hospital Johns Hopkins 2001		

Google is known for its people-centric philosophy that emphasizes employee well-being, creativity, and long-term development.

It believes in:

- **Open work culture encouraging innovation and employee voice.**
- **Generous learning budgets, 20% "innovation time" for personal projects.**
- **Extensive focus on psychological safety, inclusion, and engagement.**
- **HR policies designed around motivation, autonomy, and trust — not just output metrics**

Amazon's operational model is highly performance-driven, emphasizing efficiency, measurable output, and scalability.

It believes in:

- **Intense performance monitoring and productivity targets (especially in warehouses).**
- **Use of data analytics and algorithms to track work speed and output.**
- **Short-term labor contracts and flexible workforce deployment to meet seasonal demand.**
- **HR decisions often based on quantitative metrics and business outcomes rather than developmental needs.**

- Hard HRM (Harvard model)- Highlights the resource side where the management controls the headcount, monitors the numbers, ensures that performances match the requirements of the organization
- Soft HRM(Michigan model) – Represents the human face of HRM aimed at eliciting a commitment so that behaviour is primarily regulated. It emphasizes on achieving strategic objectives by taking people along, leading them through communication and motivation

Great Place to Work

- Every year, more than 10,000 organisations from over 60 countries partner with Great Place to Work® Institute for assessment, benchmarking, and planning actions to strengthen their workplace culture. In India, more than 1200 organisations applied to Great Place to Work® Institute to undertake the assessment year 2021, making it the largest Study in the space of Workplace Recognition.

- The Institute has an objective methodology of assessing workplace culture, that has been adopted by thousands of organisations, globally. It primarily uses 2 lenses to evaluate and identify the best cultures –
    - The first lens measures the *quality of employee experience* through their globally validated survey instrument known as Trust Index©. The survey helps in seeking anonymous feedback from employees.
    - The second lens is called Culture Audit©, a proprietary tool of the Institute that evaluates *the people practices of an organisation, covering the entire employee life cycle.*

- Identify a few organizations in the Great Place to Work survey
- List some practices which were highlighted and earned them the title.

- Evolving work and family roles
- Skills based hiring
- Wellness focus
- Influence of social media
- Diversity in organizations
- Use of metrics and analytics
- AI in HRM
- Sustainable HRM

Thank You